

2026 Crystal Ball Cup

Format

You will be presented with a series of hypothetical events. For each event, you will have one minute to submit a probability $p \in [0, 1]$ that the event occurs before the end of 2026.

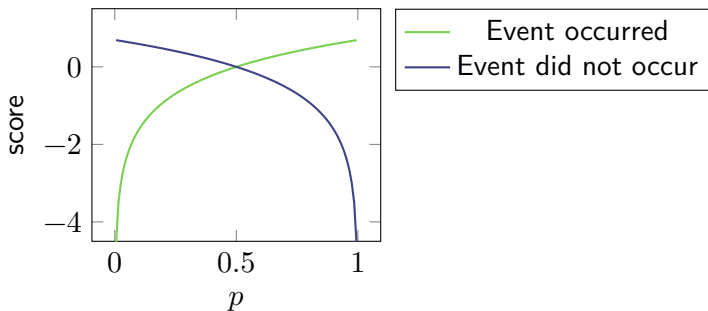
No discussion is allowed except for clarifying questions.

You may not consult external resources. You may not collude with each other to affect the outcome of any event before 2027-01-01.

Scoring

On 2027-01-01, I will compute your score to be the sum of your scores across all events. Your score on one event with submitted probability p is the logarithmic scoring rule defined as:

$$\text{score}(p) = \begin{cases} \ln p - \ln 0.5 & \text{if the event occurred} \\ \ln(1 - p) - \ln 0.5 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$



Retrospective

On some day early next year we will reconvene to evaluate our 2026 predictions and make predictions for 2027.

Form

Events

1. Grand Theft Auto VI is released

gta

Rockstar Games releases GTA VI for sale to the public.

2. The GOP holds 52 or more Senate seats

After the 2026 Midterms, the Republican party holds 52 or more seats in the U.S. Senate.

3. Lionel Messi plays in the World Cup

messi

Lionel Messi plays (starts or substitutes) in at least one match for Argentina in the 2026 FIFA World Cup.

4. Artemis II successfully flies around the moon

NASA's Artemis II mission launches, carries a crew around the moon, and returns safely to Earth.

5. A participant is a Top 0.05% Stan stan

At least one participant is notified in their Spotify Wrapped that they are in the Top 0.05% (or higher) of listeners for a specific artist.

6. Avengers: Doomsday opens to \$250M Domestic

avengers

The film Avengers: Doomsday earns more than \$250 million at the domestic box office in its opening weekend.

7. The U.S. economy enters a recession

recession

The National Bureau of Economic Research declares a recession.

8. The Sagrada Família completes the “Jesus Tower”

jesus

The central “Tower of Jesus Christ” is declared structurally complete.

9. Apple announces a foldable iPhone

iphone

Apple officially reveals a foldable smartphone model during their annual September keynote.

10. BTS performs a reunion concert

bts

The K-pop group BTS performs live together as a full group (seven members) following their military service.

11. The President is impeached

impeach

The House of Representatives votes to impeach the President.

12. LeBron James retires

lebron

LeBron James announces his retirement from professional basketball.

13. The Guggenheim Abu Dhabi opens

guggenheim

The Guggenheim Abu Dhabi museum officially opens its doors to the public.

14. Oscars Best Picture is a streaming movie

oscars

The winner of Best Picture at the 98th Academy Awards is a film distributed primarily by a streaming service (e.g., Apple, Netflix, Amazon).

15. Eli Lilly's weight loss pill is FDA approved

orforglipron

The FDA officially approves Eli Lilly's oral GLP-1 agonist, orforglipron, for chronic weight management.

16. We record 10,000 miles run on Strava

strava

The collective running distance recorded by all participants on Strava in 2026 exceeds 10,000 miles.

17. The US President attends the Semiquincentennial in Philly

semiquincentennial

On July 4, 2026 (the 250th anniversary of the US), the sitting US President delivers a speech at Independence Hall in Philadelphia.

18. A release date for The Winds of Winter is announced

game of thrones

George R. R. Martin announces the release date for The Winds of Winter.

19. USA wins more silver medals than gold medals at the 2026 Winter Olympics

medals

The number of silver medals the United States of America wins exceeds the number of gold medals the country wins at the 2026 Winter Olympics.

20. Participants visit Korea more than six times

korea

The group takes a collective total of more than six round-trips to South Korea in 2026.